TEACHER GUIDE

AQA A-level Business (7132)

Managing the human resource flow



3.6 Human resource management

3.6.3 Making human resource decisions: managing the human resource flow

A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise managing the human resource flow on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min	45 min	60 min	75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same. Your Live screen shows each task and every firm's answer.

1 Promotion risk

Round 1

You promote your best salesperson to sales manager.

Which risk is most likely?

- **A** They do not know the firm
- **B** High advertising costs
- **C** Staff see no route to promotion
- **D** You lose a top seller to replace

ANSWER

✓ You lose a top seller to replace

Why: Internal promotion leaves a gap where the best seller used to sell.

2 Cost of turnover

Round 1

Labour turnover at your firm doubled this year.

Which two costs are most likely to rise?

- **A** Hiring and training new staff
- **B** Lost sales while new staff learn
- **C** Overtime to cover idle staff
- **D** Pensions for long-serving staff
- **E** Redundancy pay

ANSWER

✓ Hiring and training new staff
✓ Lost sales while new staff learn

Why: Each leaver must be replaced and trained, and new staff sell less at first.

3 Labour turnover

Round 2

Three branches: staff on average, and how many left this year.

Order by labour turnover, lowest first?

- **A** 50 staff, 10 left
- **B** 24 staff, 6 left
- **C** 80 staff, 12 left

ANSWER

1. 80 staff, 12 left
2. 50 staff, 10 left
3. 24 staff, 6 left

Why: Turnover 15%, 20%, 25%: the fewest leavers is the highest rate.

Topic tasks

4 Staff to recruit

Round 2

Plan the workshop staff for next year.

How many must you recruit?

Technicians needed next year	**23 staff**
Technicians now	**20 staff**
Labour turnover a year	**25%**

ANSWER

8 staff

25% of 20 = 5 leave; 23 − 15 = 8

Why: Recruit for growth and for the staff who leave.

5 Full or part time

Round 3

Most buyers come on Saturdays; weekdays are quiet.

Which staffing should you choose, and why?

A Part-time staff for weekends

B More full-time staff all week

ANSWER

✓ Part-time staff for weekends

Why: Part-time staff match the cost of staff to the busy times.

6 Why a role-play

Round 3

Applicants must sell a car to a manager in a role-play before any job offer.

Why is this better than an interview alone?

A It attracts more applicants

B It replaces induction training

C It tests the skill the job needs

D It is cheaper than an interview

ANSWER

✓ It tests the skill the job needs

Why: A role-play shows how well each applicant sells, so selection is more reliable.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions on managing the human resource flow. They come from these 8 questions.

Then each pupil writes one short answer: “Evaluate flexible contracts for your sales staff.”

1 A dealer promotes its best salesperson to sales manager instead of advertising outside. What is a main advantage?
✔ **The person already knows the business**

2 A workshop needs an EV specialist no current employee can become quickly. Why recruit externally?
✔ **It brings skills the firm does not have**

3 A document lists the duties and reporting line of a service adviser. What is it?
✔ **A job description**

4 Which item belongs in a person specification for a technician?
✔ **A recognised vehicle technician qualification**

5 What is induction training for a newly hired sales adviser?
✔ **Introducing the firm, its rules and systems**

6 Technicians learn a new diagnostic system at the maker’s training centre for three days. Which type of training is this?
✔ **Off-the-job training**

7 Training six technicians costs £900 each plus £350 of lost output each. The dealer expects £9,000 extra profit in the first year. What is the first-year net gain?
✔ **£1,500**

8 A dealer’s new recruits keep leaving within three months. Which change to selection is most likely to help?
✔ **Use a realistic work trial before offering the job**